Prerequisite

Restricted to sophomore status or higher in the College of Engineering

Instructor

John C. Tompkins

Phone:765-496-0296

Email: jctompki@purdue.edu

Office: Hampton 4111

Office Hours:1-2pm TR

Class Times and Locations

Lecture 001 3:30-4:20pm W, HAMP 1252

Recitation 002 1:30-2:20pm W, HAMP 2123

Recitation 003 2:30-3:20pm W, HAMP 2113

CE 292
Contemporary Issues in Civil Engineering

Course materials are undergoing remediation per the ADA Title II Ruling. Efforts are being made to the best of my ability to ensure that course materials are ADA compliant; however, these materials have not been vetted by a third party. If you are having difficulties accessing materials, please contact me immediately for support. Any materials needing further remediation will be completed by the beginning of Fall 2026.

Course Description

his course provides a forum on issues in the civil engineering profession in a contemporary context. Topics include professionalism and ethics, entrepreneurship, cultural differences, and global collaboration. Students interact with engineering faculty as well as professionals from outside the university who provide guidance on the preparation of individual plans of study and information on civil engineering career options. Students learn and apply fundamental aspects of written communication in professional settings. Emphasis is placed on delivery of technical and managerial content.

Resources

Text: *Why Place Matters: Geography, Identity, and Civic Life in Modern America* edited by Wilfred McClay and Ted McAllister

All other needed material is available on Brightspace

Learning Outcomes

Through a combination of large-format lectures and practice-focused recitations, this course introduces students to the world of civil engineering: its ethics, tools and technologies, global business, and career paths. By the end of the semester students should be able to do the following:

1. Apply standards of effective professional communication for a range of audiences to the most common writing tasks required by the school and profession of civil engineering
2. Recognize and apply ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments
3. Consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and social contexts
4. Use appropriate learning strategies to acquire and apply new knowledge as needed, especially as it applies to specialization within the field

Assignments

There are three kinds of assignments: writing exercises, ethics exercises, and reader memos. Writing and ethics exercises test comprehension of course material and are completed in recitation. If you cannot attend recitation, you are responsible for making other arrangements with me before Friday of the week you missed. Reader memos ask you to reflect on the place of engineering in civilization. Reader memos are due approximately every 4 weeks on Friday by end of day.

No assignment will be accepted once its due date has passed. No class work may be revised once graded.

Grading Scale

All points gained throughout the semester add to a sum which determines your final letter grade. Point totals receive final letter grades according to the following scale: 90+=A, 80-89=B, 70-79=C, 60-69=D, below 60=F.

Note that CE 29202 is a core class for the school of civil engineering. Students must pass with a C or better to continue in the major.

Attendance and Academic Guidance

As the lectures for this class will be dedicated to visits from industry guests, attendance is important: our guests are volunteering their time. Two unexcused

absences are permitted (-5 pts. per unexcused absence thereafter). A perfect attendance record in lecture will be worth 5 points at the end of the semester. Absences may be excused providing notice is given in a timely fashion.

Students are expected to attend all classes unless they are ill or otherwise unable. If you are ill or exhibit symptoms of illness, stay home. If you find yourself unable to progress in the course, notify me as soon as possible. Arrangements will be made on a case-by-case basis.

All standard Purdue University policies apply to this class.

Course Schedule

Table 1

Week	Lecture Subject	Reading Assignment
January 14	*Careers and Employment*	Gary Toth
January 21	*Architectural Engineering*	Dana Gioia
January 28	*Construction Engineering*	Russell Jacoby
February 4	*Environmental Engineering*	Mark T. Mitchell
February 11	*Geomatics*	Yi-Fu Tuan
February 18	*Geotechnical Engineering*	Witold Rybczynski
February 25	*Hydraulic & Hydrologic Engineering*	Philip Bess
March 4	*Materials Engineering*	Roger Scruton
March 11	*Structural Engineering (Bridges)*	William A. Schambra
March 25	*Structural Engineering (Buildings)*	Brian Brown
April 1	*Transportation Engineering*	Christine Rosen
April 8	*Site-Civil Engineering*	Ted V. McAllister

Table 1

April 15	*Forensic Engineering*	Pete Peterson
April 22	*Right of Way/Public Sector*	Joseph A. Amato
April 29	*Make-up*	Wilfred McClay